Chapel of the Plague Priestesses

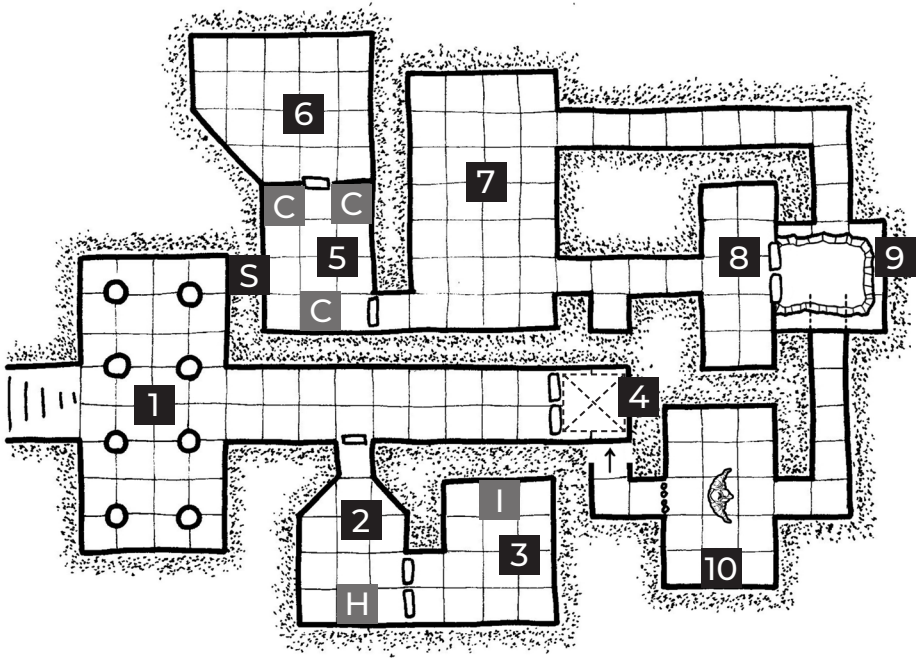
A dark sisterhood gathers in a decrepit hall beneath the city streets!

The plague priestesses huddle in their dusty temple that once served a long-forgotten god. Sobs of glorious suffering echo in the halls, and petitioners who are ill enough may touch the fabled ***Idol of Anguish*** to merge with those who share their holy rot and torment!

RANDOM ENCOUNTERS

d4	Details
1	A **gt. spider** slinks on the ceiling
2	Four **peasants** with the Rat Plague stagger into sight
3	1d6 **gt. rats** pour out of a crack
4	**Noxious gas!** DC 12 CON or 1d6 damage and paralyzed 1d4 rds

Idol of Anguish. A jet black statuette of a figure curled in pain. A mortally ill person who touches the figurine dies and transfers their soul into it, merging with dozens of others. This rich cache of souls is worth 500 gp to an evil sorcerer.



Pit Trap: Weight triggers, DC 12 DEX or fall 20'

S Secret Door: Sliding wall panel

Shadowdark RPG
3rd-Level
K. Dionne, 2026

1. Pillars of Pain. Low, cramped hall. Stinks of putrefying rats. Eight coughing **peasants** in rags lie dying around black marble **pillars** graven with vulture-women (one carving on each pillar has a ruby eye worth 30 gp). DC 12 CON if touching a peasant or contract rat plague (see **rat** stats). 1:6 chance each round 3 **cultists** from Area 5 open the **secret door** to reverently take a peasant to Area 6 or rebuke PCs looting rubies.

- **Secret Door.** Pinprick viewing holes visible in close range. Leads to Area 5.

2. Sister Secunda. Sister Horatia (**cultist**, HP 18, +4 spellcasting, 2 spells per round, LV 4) kneels on a filth-encrusted mat in prayer. Crimson boils cover half her face. She's young and ambitious; will help PCs depose Sister Irithia in Area 3 so she may take her place as leader.

3. Sister Primaria. Sister Irithia (**mage**) reads a prayer tome at her desk. She is old, harsh, and as still as a corpse. Her eyes are clouded with rot, yet she sees clearly. She is the Overlord's first cousin (a shameful family secret), and she offers her political influence in alliance. Her "crutch" is a *Staff of the Cobra*.

4. Pit Trap. Triggered by weight. DC 12 DEX or fall 20' (2d6). Lid closes in 1d4 rounds. Tunnel at the bottom of pit leads to iron bars (DC 15 STR to bend).

5. Death Vigil. 3 veiled, leprous **cultists** (Sisters Marabeth, Leora, and Elin) watch Area 1 through the **secret door**. Sister Elin's secret love, a peasant named **Hargold**, lies dying in Area 1; she is torn between her zealous belief in glorious suffering and her desire for him to live.

- **Secret Door.** Pinprick viewing holes visible in close range. Leads to Area 1.

6. Idol Chamber. An unnaturally cold room with dense shadows that writhe in the corner of vision. The ***Idol of Anguish*** (see reverse) sits on an altar laden with rotting fruit, tarnished silver bells and lamps (5 items, 5 gp each), and a deeply pockmarked skull encased in copper (20 gp). Three **shadows** emerge from the *Idol* to defend it if a healthy person touches it (once per day).

7. Hall of Prayer. Tiny rattles and silver chimes hang on blood-crusted **cords** along the walls (praying to the Plague Mother while rustling the cords grants 1 luck token, limit 1/day). A wide **circle** on the floor painted with blood and excrement confers rat plague to anyone who willingly lies down inside it.

8. Burial Shrouds. Wall shelves hold a dozen linen **burial shrouds** painted with prayers for decay, wilting, and putrescence. Hidden within one is a *Scroll of Blind/Deafen*. The eye-watering **stench** of rot leaks under the bronze double doors to the east.

9. Corpse Pit. Unbearable **stench** (DC 12 CON on first whiff or vomiting for 1d4 rounds). A 20' deep **pit** fills the room; a pile of rotting bodies in white shrouds covers the bottom of it. A thin **walkway** traverses the outside (DC 12 DEX or fall into pit). A **tunnel** at the bottom of the pit leads south to Area 10.

10. Idol of the Plague Mother. Thin, distant wails of suffering rise and fall on a silent wind. A 12' **statue** of a stooped, veiled woman stands with arms out. Kissing her pox-ravaged feet grants 5 XP (1/person). The north **tunnel** opens to the bottom of the pit in Area 9. Iron **bars** block passage west (DC 15 STR to bend).